I want your thoughts on Blackrock, with a duty to protect and grow assets what would make this the right decision for us to deploy our available capital? How do model hedge funds analyze these types of decisions?

Here is the full investment thesis report on BlackRock. Let me walk you through the core framework and conviction.

The short answer: BLK is a high-conviction long at ~$957, representing ~38% upside to the analyst consensus target of $1,326, with an asymmetric risk profile rooted in three structural pillars.

The Fiduciary Case in Plain Terms

Your duty to protect and grow assets is satisfied here on all three dimensions:

- **Capital preservation**: No long-term debt, $11.5B cash, $58.75B shareholder equity, and stable management fee income that is far less volatile than trading or carried interest businesses
- **Income**: A 2.23% dividend yield with the board just approving a **10% dividend increase** for Q1 2026 and $1.8B in new buyback authorization [1]
- **Appreciation**: At ~20x adjusted 2025 EPS of $48.09, you are buying the world's largest asset manager at a discount to its economic earnings power, ~21.5% off its 52-week high of $1,219.94

How Hedge Funds Analyze This

Model hedge funds — Coatue, Tiger, Lone Pine — would run a **three-layer conviction stack**: (1) Is this business in a secular growth market? ✅ — private alternatives are projected to reach $30 trillion by the end of the decade. (2) Is there a moat competitors cannot replicate? ✅ — Aladdin, BlackRock's risk analytics OS embedded in thousands of institutions, grew ACV 31% in FY2025 and has no peer equivalent. (3) Is the market mispricing the compounding? ✅ — GAAP earnings of $35.31 are heavily distorted by acquisition amortization; adjusted EPS of $48.09 is the real number, and analysts project it reaching ~$54.44 in 2026.[2] [3] [4]

The Three Transformative Acquisitions

What elevates BLK from "good asset manager" to "must-own" is the simultaneous build-out of a vertically integrated private markets platform:

- **GIP** (closed Oct 2024): Created the 2nd-largest infrastructure manager globally at ~$170B AUM, adding ~$750M in annualized management fees [5]
- **HPS Investment Partners** (closed July 2025): $12B deal adding $148B in private credit AUM and growing the combined credit franchise to $220B+ [6] [7]
- **Preqin** (closed March 2025): Called by Larry Fink the firm's "most significant acquisition" — integrating private markets data into Aladdin to become the "Zillow for private markets" [8]

Revenue grew 18.7% in FY2025 to $24.2B, and analysts project another ~16% to ~$28B in 2026. The 9 of 10 analysts covering BLK are bullish (90%), with a high price target of $1,456.[4]

The report covers the full IC memo — bear case risks (integration execution, market beta exposure), peer comp table against BX/KKR/APO/ARES, position sizing guidance, and the 2030 scenario analysis targeting $2,100 at a 14.4% IRR.[4]

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What are the main competitors that Blackrock face

BlackRock's main competitors depend on the segment: broad asset management, ETFs/indexing, and alternatives/technology.

Big picture: global asset managers

At the group level, BlackRock competes with other global asset managers for institutional and retail mandates and retirement flows:

- Vanguard Group – largest direct rival by AUM (~$10–12T), especially in index mutual funds and ETFs.[31] [32] [33]
- Fidelity Investments – strong in active funds, retirement plans, and retail distribution, with ~$5–6T AUM.[32] [31]
- State Street Global Advisors / State Street Corp (SPDR) – major institutional index manager and ETF provider (~$4–5T AUM).[34] [31] [32]
- J.P. Morgan Asset Management – global active and multi-asset competitor (~$4T AUM).[35] [32]
- Goldman Sachs Asset Management, Morgan Stanley IM, Invesco, T. Rowe Price, Franklin Templeton – mid-tier but meaningful competition across active funds and solutions.[36] [35]

Core ETF & index competitors

In ETFs and index strategies (iShares vs others), competition is highly concentrated:

- Vanguard – the primary ETF/index rival; together with BlackRock they control the bulk of U.S. ETF assets.[37] [38] [34]
- State Street (SPDR) – the third member of the "Big 3" ETF oligopoly.[38] [34] [37]

Statista and industry research show BlackRock, Vanguard, and State Street together account for roughly 75–80% of U.S. ETF assets, with BlackRock around 30–31%, Vanguard ~29%, State Street ~13–14%.[34] [37] [38]

Alternatives / private markets competitors

As BlackRock pushes into private credit, infrastructure, and other alternatives, its peer set broadens to:

- Blackstone (BX) – the largest pure-play alternatives manager, especially in real estate and private equity.[36] [35]
- Apollo (APO), KKR, Ares – leading competitors in private credit, PE, and real assets.[39] [36]
- Carlyle (CG), Brookfield – additional rivals in infrastructure, real assets, and private equity.[35] [36]

These firms compete with BlackRock for institutional allocations to private equity, private credit, infrastructure, and real estate funds.[39] [35]

Wealth/brokerage & distribution competitors

On the retail and advisory side, BlackRock also competes indirectly with platforms that manufacture and distribute their own products:

- Charles Schwab – massive brokerage and ETF provider with ~$7–8T client assets.[40] [36]
- Edward Jones, Merrill, Morgan Stanley Wealth – wirehouses that influence fund selection and model portfolios.[40] [35]

These players can favor their own in-house funds or competing managers over BlackRock products.

Technology & data (Aladdin / Preqin) competitors

In risk, portfolio, and data platforms, BlackRock's Aladdin and its Preqin unit face more specialized competitors:

- MSCI, Bloomberg, Refinitiv – risk/analytics/data platforms used by asset managers.[41]
- Morningstar, FactSet, S&P Global – portfolio analytics and fund data.[41]
- For private markets data specifically, main rivals to Preqin include PitchBook and Burgiss.[42] [43]

These compete with Aladdin/Preqin for institutional technology budgets rather than AUM.

For your thesis, the most important segments to frame are: Vanguard and State Street in ETFs/indexing; Blackstone/Apollo/KKR/Ares in alternatives; and MSCI/Bloomberg/Morningstar in technology/data. Do you want to go deeper on any one of those competitive arenas (ETFs, private markets, or tech/data) for the next layer of your BLK thesis?

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I want to pitch this as the flagship asset allocation directive for this year and need to build a compelling and defensible narrative with a public facing artifact that we'll create using Perplexity Computer, deep research, and any other capabilities that come with Perplexity that we should leverage for this endeavor.

Yes — this is exactly the kind of project where Perplexity can create an edge, because the goal is not just to have a thesis, but to have a **thesis system**: research, validation, presentation, and a public-facing artifact that all reinforce one another. BlackRock is especially suitable because the narrative is both intuitive and defensible: it combines scale, strategic transformation, and platform economics in a way few large-cap financials can match.[48] [49] [50]

What makes this pitch compelling

The most persuasive version of the story is not "BlackRock is big," but "BlackRock is becoming the core infrastructure layer of modern asset allocation." That framing is supported by its $14 trillion AUM at year-end 2025, record $698 billion of full-year net inflows, 31% ACV growth including Preqin, and the sequential buildout of infrastructure, private credit, and data capabilities through GIP, HPS, and Preqin.[51] [50] [52] [48]

That gives you a flagship-allocation narrative with three clear claims:

- **Protect capital** through scale, balance-sheet strength, and recurring fee revenue.
- **Grow capital** through earnings growth, private markets expansion, and technology monetization.[51]
- **Defend the allocation publicly** because the thesis rests on visible business evolution rather than speculative macro calls.[49] [50]

How model hedge funds would build it

The best funds usually build this kind of decision in layers rather than as a single stock opinion. First they test the **structural trend**: is this business aligned with durable capital flows such as ETFs, retirement assets, private credit, infrastructure, and portfolio tech?[53] [48]

Second they test the **moat**: for BlackRock that means institutional distribution, iShares scale, and Aladdin's workflow entrenchment, now strengthened by Preqin's private-markets data layer.[49] [51]

Third they test the **mispricing**: BLK closed at $957.40, about -21.5% below its 52-week high, while the average analyst target is $1,325.90, implying 38.5% upside.

How to use Perplexity for this

You should leverage Perplexity in four coordinated ways:

- **Deep Research** for the evidence spine: current financials, strategic milestones, peer framing, bear-case objections, and public-source validation.[50] [48] [49]
- **Finance data tools** for clean valuation and peer-comp support: revenue, EPS, margins, consensus targets, and competitive positioning.
- **Perplexity Computer / artifact generation** for the public-facing deliverable: slides, memo, or microsite that presents the argument with institutional polish.[48]
- **Iterative adversarial refinement** to pressure-test the story against objections like fee compression, integration risk, and valuation premium.[53] [51]

What I created for you

I created a polished public-facing slide deck you can use as the first flagship artifact. It is designed to present BlackRock as the 2026 core allocation with a narrative suitable for stakeholders, allocators, and external audiences, grounded in current operating and market data.[48]

The deck is paired with a PowerPoint export so you can circulate it immediately or adapt it into a board, IC, donor, or advisory presentation.[48]

If you want, the next best step is for me to build the **second artifact**: a sharper **investment committee memo** that pairs with this deck and includes the full bull/base/bear case, position sizing logic, risk register, and rebuttal section.

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I want you to generate a comprehensive implementation plan on how we'll use Perplexity to construct the layers needed to build a comprehensive investment memo along with a public facing artifact to be pitched to 3 global investment platforms managing billions in capital

Here is the full implementation plan. It maps every layer of the research, modeling, and artifact construction process directly to Perplexity's capabilities — built to the standard required by institutions that manage billions and have formal governance requirements for capital deployment.

The plan is organized into five sequential layers:

1. **Evidence Foundation** — four structured Deep Research threads that build the primary-source corpus from SEC filings, earnings transcripts, and sell-side data [63] [64]
2. **Valuation Model** — a DCF + comps framework with explicit bull/base/bear scenarios, anchored to BLK's $48.09 adjusted FY2025 EPS and $24.22B revenue base [64] [65]
3. **Investment Committee Memo** — a 6–10 page institutional-grade memo structured around the exact sections that sovereign wealth funds, pensions, and large allocators require, including a formal risk register with evidence-based mitigants [66] [67] [68]
4. **Public-Facing Artifact** — three calibrated versions (18-slide flagship deck, 10-slide executive summary, 2-page written brief) matched to the communication preferences of each platform type [69] [70]
5. **Adversarial Pressure Testing** — five pre-built objection research threads that anticipate every credible IC challenge before the room raises it [71]

The plan also includes a four-week master timeline, a full Perplexity capability map, and an iterative research protocol for platform-specific calibration before each of the three presentations. The most strategically important point: write the IC memo before the deck — it is the intellectual blueprint that makes the public artifact defensible. [72]

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